CalWORKs Program Guide: A. Community Service-Work Experience

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY - CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE

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Section 1

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY
CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE ? SECTION 10-050: COMMUNITY SERVICE
TITLE: A. COMMUNITY SERVICE AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Section 2

1. POLICY BACKGROUND & PURPOSE
Community Service provides structured, unpaid work activities in public agencies or private non-profit organizations to enable CalWORKs Welfare-to-Work (WTW) participants who cannot find unsubsidized employment to gain job skills, work history, and professional references while fulfilling their mandatory hourly participation requirements under CDSS MPP EAS 42-716.

Section 3

2. DETAILED REGULATORY STANDARDS & PLACEMENT RULES
? Maximum Hours Determination (FLSA Rule): Community service hours are strictly calculated according to Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) regulations. The maximum allowable monthly hours cannot exceed the household's monthly CalWORKs grant plus CalFresh allotment divided by the applicable California statutory minimum wage.
? Non-Displacement Protections: Community service participants cannot be placed in positions that result in the displacement of regular employees, fill existing vacant positions, or impair existing collective bargaining agreements.
? Core Participation Credit: Community service qualifies as a core WTW activity fulfilling the 20 or 30-hour weekly core participation requirement for single or two-parent assistance units.
? Supportive Services Guarantee: Participants assigned to community service placements must be provided all necessary supportive services, including child care, transportation, and required work equipment, uniforms, or safety gear.

Section 4

3. CASEWORKER OPERATING PROCEDURES & VERIFICATION CHECKLIST
? Placement Agreement: Execute the Community Service Agreement with the approved sponsor organization, specifying daily work schedules, learning objectives, and workplace supervision.
? Monthly Attendance Verification: Collect monthly attendance logs verified and signed by the workplace supervisor by the 5th working day following the

participation month.

? Skill Development Review: Evaluate participant progress at 6-month intervals to determine readiness for transition to unsubsidized employment or Expanded Subsidized Employment.